SERENE
AESTHETICS, WELLNESS AND IV INFUSION CENTER

FREE GUIDE

Wrinkle Relaxers & Fillers: A First-Timer's Guide

What they do, how much you need, what it really costs, and how to choose an injector you can trust

SERENE MED SPA · PHYSICIAN-LED

Hudson, Ohio · Barboursville, West Virginia

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Educational guide · not medical advice

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Thinking about your first injectable treatment? You are not alone, and it is normal to have questions. How much product will I need? Will it look natural? What does it really cost? What if something goes wrong?

This guide answers those questions in plain English, from dosing and cost math to aftercare and the warning signs of a deal that is too good to be true.

Serene Med Spa is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia. Our goal with this guide is simple: help you walk into any consultation informed and confident.

About Serene Med Spa

Serene is a physician-led med spa with offices in Hudson, Ohio and Barboursville, West Virginia, led by Robin Arora, MD and Shweta Arora, MD. We plan every treatment around your goals and health history, and we'll tell you plainly what a treatment can and can't do.

PART 01

Two different tools: wrinkle relaxers vs. dermal fillers

Wrinkle relaxers (neuromodulators) are a purified protein injected in tiny amounts into specific facial muscles. They calm the muscle so it cannot crease the skin as hard. That softens "expression lines," the ones that show up when you frown, raise your brows or smile with your eyes.

Dermal fillers are soft gels placed under the skin. Most fillers are made of hyaluronic acid (HA), a sugar molecule your skin already makes. Fillers add volume and support. They can restore fullness to cheeks or lips, soften deep folds, smooth hollows under the eyes and define a jawline or chin.

A simple way to remember it: wrinkle relaxers soften movement; fillers replace or add volume. Many people use both, in different areas, as part of one plan.

- Lines that show mostly when you move (frown lines, forehead lines, crow's feet) usually point to a wrinkle relaxer.
- Lines or hollows that are there even when your face is still (deep smile lines, flat cheeks, thin lips, under-eye hollows) usually point to filler.
- Some areas need a bit of both.

PART 02

Units vs. syringes: how dosing works

Wrinkle relaxers are measured in units. Your injector decides how many units each muscle needs, based on its strength, your goals and how much movement you want to keep. Stronger muscles and larger areas take more units.

As a reference point, the FDA-approved label for one widely used wrinkle relaxer lists 20 units for frown lines, 24 units for crow's feet (12 per side), and 20 units for forehead lines when treated together with frown lines. Real-world doses vary. Many first-timers start lower, and some people need more.

One important detail: units are not the same across all brands. One product on our menu is measured on a different unit scale, so you need more of its units to get a similar effect. That is why it has a lower per-unit price. Always compare the total cost for the treatment, not just the price per unit.

Fillers are measured in syringes, usually about 1 mL each. Some areas need only a half syringe, while larger areas may need two or more.

- Lips: often a half syringe (0.5 mL) to 1 syringe for a first treatment
- Cheeks: often 1 to 2 syringes, split between both sides
- Under-eyes: often a half syringe to 1 syringe total, placed with care
- Chin: often 1 to 2 syringes; jawline: often 2 or more
- Smile lines: often 1 to 2 syringes

> **These are starting points, not a prescription**
>
> Your face, age, skin quality and goals all change the plan. Our physician-led team will tell you a realistic amount at your consultation so there are no surprises.

PART 03

How long results usually last

Wrinkle relaxers start to soften lines in about 3 to 5 days. Full results usually show at around 2 weeks. Most people see results last about 3 to 4 months, then muscle movement slowly returns. Many people book maintenance visits 3 to 4 times a year.

HA fillers show results right away, though swelling can hide the final look for 1 to 2 weeks. Results generally last about 6 months to over a year, depending on the product and the area. Areas that move a lot, like the lips, tend to fade sooner than areas like the cheeks or chin.

Collagen stimulators such as Sculptra work differently. They encourage your body to build its own collagen over time, so results appear gradually across a series of visits. Results vary, and no injectable lasts forever.

PART 04

"Baby" doses and starting early

A "baby" dose is a smaller amount of wrinkle relaxer spread across an area. The goal is a softer result that keeps more natural movement. It is popular with first-timers and anyone who wants to look rested rather than "done."

Some people in their 20s and 30s use small doses to soften movement before lines become deeply etched. The idea makes sense, because repeated creasing helps form lines over time. But strong long-term evidence that early treatment prevents future wrinkles is limited, so think of it as a personal choice, not a must.

The trade-off: smaller doses may wear off a bit sooner than a standard dose.

> **Good to know**
>
> At Serene, a 20-unit "baby" wrinkle-relaxer dose is listed at $220 in Hudson and $200 in Barboursville. A lip flip (a few units to relax the upper lip so it rolls out slightly) is listed at $80 for 8 units in Barboursville.

PART 05

Doing the cost math at Serene

For wrinkle relaxers, multiply units by the price per unit. For fillers, multiply syringes by the price per syringe.

Our most common wrinkle relaxers are $11 per unit in Hudson and $10 per unit in Barboursville. Most filler syringes are $500 at both offices, and a half syringe of lip filler (0.5 mL) is $300.

- Frown lines at 20 units: about $220 in Hudson or $200 in Barboursville.
- Frown lines plus crow's feet at 44 units: about $484 in Hudson or $440 in Barboursville.
- Frown lines, forehead and crow's feet at 64 units: about $704 in Hudson or $640 in Barboursville. Many people need fewer units than this.
- Yearly budget: if you keep 44 units 3 to 4 times a year, plan on roughly $1,452 to $1,936 in Hudson or $1,320 to $1,760 in Barboursville.
- Two syringes of cheek filler: about $1,000 at either office.
- Bundle of three Juvéderm syringes: $1,400 in Hudson or $1,300 in Barboursville, which is less than buying three single syringes at $500 each.
- New clients: "20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount". For example, 44 units in Hudson would drop from $484 to $387.20.

> **Barboursville price match**
> Our Barboursville office will match any published Tri-State price on injectables. The match applies to the same product, treatment and quantity at a licensed medical provider within 30 miles of Barboursville, WV. The price must be currently published (website or printed menu), and it can't be combined with other offers or rewards.

PART 06

What to expect on treatment day

Your visit starts with a conversation. You will share your goals, your medical history and any medications or supplements you take. Your injector will study how your face moves, then explain a plan and the total cost before anything is done. If you are a good candidate, treatment can often happen the same day.

Wrinkle relaxer treatment is quick, usually about 10 to 15 minutes. It feels like a few small pinches. Tiny bumps at the injection points usually fade in 15 to 30 minutes.

Filler appointments take a bit longer, usually 30 to 45 minutes. Most fillers contain a numbing medicine, and a topical numbing cream may also be used. You may feel pressure and some tenderness. You will see a change right away, but swelling is common at first, especially in the lips.

Most people return to normal activities right away. Before a big event, plan treatment at least 2 weeks ahead.

- Tell us if you are pregnant, trying to get pregnant or breastfeeding. Most injectors advise waiting.

- Tell us about blood thinners, pain relievers and supplements. Do not stop any prescribed medicine without talking to the doctor who prescribed it.
- Bring photos of looks you like and looks you want to avoid.

PART 07

Aftercare: the first 48 hours

Good aftercare is simple and helps protect your result.

- Wrinkle relaxers, first 4 to 6 hours: stay upright, don't rub or press the treated area, and skip hats, tight headbands and facials.
- Wrinkle relaxers, first 24 hours: avoid hard workouts, alcohol and high heat like saunas and hot tubs.
- Fillers, first 24 hours: don't touch or massage the area, use ice in 10-minute intervals, sleep with your head raised, stay hydrated, and avoid hard workouts, alcohol, salty foods and heat.
- Lip filler: expect more swelling the next morning, limit straw use on day one, and know that small lumps usually soften over 1 to 2 weeks.
- Both treatments, first 48 hours: avoid facial massage, peels, microneedling and laser treatments. Try to sleep on your back.
- Book a 2-week check if your injector recommends one.

PART 08

Bruising, rare risks and how complications are handled

Common and usually mild: swelling, redness, tenderness, small bruises and, after wrinkle relaxers, a brief headache or tight feeling. Filler swelling usually improves within 2 to 5 days. Bruises can take a week or more to fade.

Less common with wrinkle relaxers: a heavy or drooping eyelid or brow, or an uneven look. In clinical trials for one product, eyelid drooping happened in about 2% to 3% of people treated for frown or forehead lines. These effects wear off as the product does. Very rarely, the effect can spread beyond the injection area. Trouble swallowing, speaking or breathing, or vision changes, need urgent medical care.

Rare but serious with fillers: if filler enters a blood vessel, it can block blood flow. The FDA notes this risk is low, but it can cause skin damage, vision problems including blindness, or stroke. Warning signs include severe pain, skin that turns white, gray or blotchy, or any vision change. These need help right away.

This is where a physician-led team matters. HA fillers can be dissolved with an enzyme if needed, and filler reversal is on our menu. Our physicians oversee treatment plans, screen your medical history, and are involved if something does not look or feel right.

> **Call or text right away if you notice**
>
> Severe or worsening pain, skin color changes near a filler site, vision changes, a drooping eyelid, or any trouble swallowing or breathing. For trouble breathing or vision loss, call 911 first.

PART 09

How to choose an injector, and the red flags of cheap deals

The product matters, but the person holding the syringe matters more. Look for a licensed medical provider with specific training in facial anatomy and injectables, working under real medical oversight. Ask how they handle complications.

Price shopping is smart, but very low prices can hide problems. In 2024, the CDC warned about serious illness linked to counterfeit or mishandled wrinkle-relaxer injections, often given by unlicensed people or in non-medical settings. The FDA also warns against fillers bought online, which may be fake or unapproved.

- Prices far below what licensed clinics in your area charge
- "Per area" pricing with no clear number of units
- The injector won't tell you the product name, or won't show the box and lot number
- Injections at house parties, salons or anywhere that is not a medical setting
- No medical history, no consent form, and no doctor involved
- Pressure to buy extra syringes or prepay large packages on the spot
- No plan for follow-up or for handling problems after hours

Wrinkle relaxers vs. dermal fillers at a glance

	Wrinkle relaxers (neuromodulators)	Dermal fillers (mostly hyaluronic acid)
What it does	Relaxes the muscle that creases the skin	Adds volume, lift and support under the skin
Good for	Frown lines, forehead lines, crow's feet, lip flip, jaw muscle	Lips, cheeks, under-eyes, chin, jawline, smile lines, hands
Measured in	Units	Syringes (about 1 mL each)
When you see results	Starts in 3 to 5 days; full at about 2 weeks	Right away; settles over 1 to 2 weeks
How long it usually lasts	About 3 to 4 months	About 6 months to over a year, by product and area
Treatment time	About 10 to 15 minutes	About 30 to 45 minutes
Can it be reversed?	No; it wears off on its own	HA fillers can be dissolved if needed
Typical price at Serene	$11/unit Hudson; $10/unit Barboursville	$500/syringe; $300 half-syringe lips

What it costs at Serene

Treatment	Hudson, OH	Barboursville, WV
Wrinkle relaxers (most products), per unit Price per standard unit	$11	$10
Wrinkle relaxer on a different unit scale, per unit Takes more units for a similar effect; compare total cost	$3.99	$3.99
"Baby" wrinkle-relaxer dose (20 units) Softer, lighter result	$220	$200
Lip flip (8 units) Relaxes the upper lip muscle	See current pricing	$80
Lip filler, half syringe (0.5 mL) Popular first lip treatment	$300	$300
Lip filler, full syringe (1 mL)	$500	$500
Cheek, under-eye, jawline or hand filler, per syringe Many areas need 1 to 2+ syringes	$500	$500
Radiesse, per syringe	$500	$500
Three Juvéderm syringes (bundle) Lower than three single syringes	$1,400	$1,300
SKINVIVE by Juvéderm, per syringe Skin-quality treatment	$400	$400
Sculptra, per vial Collagen stimulator; usually a series	$750	$600
Filler reversal (dissolving) For HA fillers	$150+	$150+

Prices as of October 2026; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. Prices are starting points and your final cost is confirmed at your consultation.

Your consultation checklist

- [ ] Who will do my injections, and what is their training and medical license?
- [ ] Is a physician involved in my plan and available if a problem comes up?
- [ ] Which product will you use, and can I see the box and lot number?
- [ ] How many units or syringes do you recommend, and what will the total cost be?
- [ ] What result is realistic for me, and how long is it likely to last?
- [ ] What side effects should I expect, and which signs mean I should call right away?
- [ ] How do you handle complications, including dissolving filler if needed?
- [ ] Do you offer a follow-up visit at about 2 weeks?
- [ ] Have I shared all my medications, supplements, allergies and health conditions?
- [ ] Is treatment at least 2 weeks before my next big event?

Frequently asked questions

Will I look frozen or overdone?

Not if the plan is built around your goals. A skilled injector adjusts the dose to keep natural movement. If you are worried, start with a smaller dose. It is easy to add a little more at a follow-up visit.

Does it hurt?

Most people describe wrinkle relaxers as a few quick pinches. Fillers can feel like pressure and some tenderness, but most fillers contain a numbing medicine, and numbing cream can help.

Can I get wrinkle relaxers and filler on the same day?

Often, yes. Many people combine them, such as wrinkle relaxers for the forehead and filler for the cheeks or lips. Your injector will advise on timing for your plan.

What happens if I stop?

Your face gradually returns to how it would have looked without treatment. Wrinkle relaxers wear off over a few months, and fillers are slowly absorbed by your body. Stopping does not make lines worse than before.

Why is one wrinkle relaxer only $3.99 per unit?

That product uses a different unit scale, so a treatment takes more of its units. The total cost often ends up in a similar range. Ask for the total price for your treatment, not just the per-unit number.

Who should not get injectables?

Most injectors advise waiting during pregnancy and breastfeeding. People with certain nerve or muscle conditions, an active skin infection at the site, or allergies to product ingredients may not be good candidates. Your medical history review will cover this.

Can you promise a certain result?

No one can. Results vary and depend on your anatomy, skin, lifestyle and the product used. A good consultation sets realistic expectations up front.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Ready when you are

- Book a consultation online: Hudson at https://serenemedspas.com/hudson/ or Barboursville at https://serenemedspas.com/barboursville/.
- Prefer to text? Hudson: (330) 303-2031. Barboursville: (304) 396-0295. Send us your questions before you book.
- New clients: "20% off your first visit — applies to any product or service; can't be combined with another discount".
- Found a lower published injectables price nearby? Ask our Barboursville office about its Tri-State price match.



Hudson, Ohio

50 W Streetsboro St, Suite 2
Text (330) 303-2031 · Call (330) 460-5915
serenemedspas.com/hudson



Barboursville, West Virginia

1 Chateau Grove Ln
Text (304) 396-0295 · Call (304) 520-0461
serenemedspas.com/barboursville

Scan a code to see pricing and book online.

Important

This guide is for general education only and is not medical advice. It does not replace a consultation with a licensed medical provider. Injectable treatments carry risks, and results vary from person to person; no specific outcome is promised. Dosing and syringe amounts shown are general ranges, and your provider will recommend a plan based on your health and goals. Prices are as of October 2026 and may change; see serenemedspas.com for current pricing. If you have a medical emergency, call 911.

Sources

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